

Course Syllabus ▲↓

Course and Instructor Information

Instructor: Alfredo Effendy

Email: aeffendy@uw.edu (<mailto:aeffendy@uw.edu>)

Class Meeting Time: MW 3:30 - 5:30PM @UW2-031

Office: UW1-320

Office Hours: Wednesday 2:00 - 3:00 PM *in-person* & Thursday 1:00 - 2:00 PM *via Zoom* 


Course Description

This course introduces students to the fundamental concepts of macroeconomics, the study of the aggregate economy. We start with a review of comparative advantage and apply the concept to international trade. Next, we look at key variables such as GDP, inflation, unemployment, and interest rates to explain both the current state of the economy as well as movements and business fluctuations in the economy. We will study the monetary system, discuss the role of savings and capital formation in the economy, and conclude the course with a review of fiscal and monetary policy.

Course Objectives

The objective of this course is to familiarize you with the macroeconomics vocabulary, to investigate a variety of macroeconomic issues such as unemployment, inflation, GDP, and shocks to aggregate economic activity, and to use theories and models that will help you understand and evaluate the potential and the limits of the monetary and fiscal policies.

Textbook and Classroom Materials

Macroeconomics 5th Edition, by Paul Krugman and Robin Wells (Recommended). You are welcome to use the previous edition, but you are responsible for checking that the assigned readings coincide with the official version. Additional readings and assignments might be posted on the Canvas website.

A laptop computer, tablet or smart phones with Wi-Fi connectivity will be required for accessing class materials. The student is responsible for loss of text / data due to power failure, internet failure

or malfunction of the device. The student must make sure to have a backup plan in case they experience such a problem.

Canvas

Access to the Canvas learning management system is required. It is recommended that students check the Canvas course website at least once between class meetings. Students may set up notifications in Canvas so that they are automatically alerted to new Canvas emails and announcements. Please use the following for any needed assistance [Canvas Help](https://uwconnect.uw.edu/it?id=kb_article_view&sysparm_article=KB0034575) (https://uwconnect.uw.edu/it?id=kb_article_view&sysparm_article=KB0034575).

Technology Help

If you need help with the class technology, please email UWB IT at uwbit@uw.edu. They provide support for the UWB Learning Technologies, not the instructor.

Course Structure

1. Class meets **in-person**, during the scheduled time. We will have class exercises, discussions and, time permitting, questions and answers. Attendance of each class is expected. Class meetings **are not** recorded.
2. Lecture Slides will be posted prior to the class meeting and the Lecture Notes will be posted soon after the class meeting.
3. There will be a Review Session for each of the exam that will take place during the lecture prior to the exam.
4. Attend the office hours if you have any extra helps outside the lecture time. Please, do not postpone asking for help.

Grading

Exams are "closed-book" individual assignment. You have to memorize all the information. You are allowed to use a basic or scientific/graphing calculator. You are not allowed to use your phone as a calculator. All books, papers, notebooks etc. must be placed inside your bag (backpack etc.) and the bag must be securely and fully closed. Baseball caps with visors, tinted glasses and any kinds of gear hiding your eyes are not permitted. You are not allowed to either give or receive aid on these examinations and you must comply with all of the rules of these examinations. Failure to comply with these rules represents academic misconduct. It is your responsibility to read the instructions for each examination carefully before starting the tests. Students are expected to uphold the academic integrity standards specified in the UW Student Conduct Code (WAC 478-120-010-145).

The Final Grade for this course will be calculated based on the following format/weighting:

- Problem Sets (20%)
- Article Responses (15%)

- Midterm Exam (30%)
- Final Exam (35%)

The Final Grade will be curved **IF** needed, at the end of the quarter. Individual assignments are not assigned GPA grades. The Final Grade to GPA conversion will be posted at the end of the quarter as well.

Problem Sets (20%)

Throughout the course I will post five problem sets assignments on the Canvas website. These will be graded for correctness, but the lowest scores will be dropped from your grade. Late submission will be deducted 50% per day.

Article Responses (15%)

You will turn in two short economic essays this quarter. For each, you are to find a news article *from The New York Times, The Financial Times, or The Wall Street Journal* that is published after January 1, 2026. The goal is to apply the economic knowledge that you learn from this course to a real-world application, so when you read the news, you can think about the economic intuition behind it. You should use the graphs that you learn from this course. The paper should be no more than two pages long, including the graph. The grades will be based on how well you relate the article to course material, how clearly and correctly you summarize the issue at hand and the economic behind the topic, and the clarity and correctness of your graph.

Exams (65%)

There will be a Midterm Exam, lasting 90 minutes, and a cumulative Final Exam, lasting 2 hours. These are individual assignments. There will be no make-up examinations given for the midterm; if you are unable to take the Midterm Exam, the weight of that Midterm Exam in your final grade will be transferred to your performance on the cumulative Final Exam. You must take the exams at the scheduled date and time. You will NOT be able to take the exams at your convenience.

All students must take the Final Exam in person at the scheduled time in order to receive credit for the course. The midterm grade will be replaced with the Final Exam grade, provided the Final Exam grade is higher. The Final Exam always counts towards your final grade. Students must comply with all the rules of the exam. Failing to do so will result in the termination of your exam time. A student absent from the Final Exam due to a reason judged by the instructor to be unavoidable, will be eligible for a make-up examination on TBA. Please note that it is the student's responsibility to inform me at the time of the regular scheduled Final Exam, or earlier, that they are unable to take the regular final exam and request the make-up Final Exam. The questions on the make-up examination will be different from the regular scheduled final examination. Examples of unavoidable cause include death or serious illness in the immediate family, illness of the student, and, provided previous notification is given, observance of regularly scheduled religious obligations. Students who miss the Final Exam and either do not qualify for the make-up exam or fail to notify the instructor as mentioned above, will receive 0 points on the Final Exam.

Grade Changes

Any change of grade in an assignment or exam must be requested in writing with a clear explanation of why any modification should be made. Such a request will only be accepted within one week of when I returned the graded material to the class and the whole assignment or exam will be re-graded.

Participation

Regular & on-time in-person class attendance is expected. You will be expected to participate during every class meeting. Please be prepared to be called upon at any time. If you think you have problems with the material, please see me for help at your earliest convenience. Students who engage in disruptive behavior during any class will be asked to leave the meeting and will forfeit any points associated with graded work on that day.

Academic Integrity

Students are NOT allowed to collaborate with other students when taking exams, quizzes and clicker questions. You are not allowed to either give or receive aid on these examinations and you must comply with all rules of these examinations. Plagiarism, cheating or any kind of fraud will not be tolerated. If a student is found responsible for academic misconduct related to an assignment, the student will receive 0 points on that assignment. Students are expected to read, know, and uphold the academic integrity standards specified in the Student Conduct Code for the University of Washington (WAC 478-120-010-145): [Student Conduct Code](#) 

(<https://app.leg.wa.gov/wac/default.aspx?cite=478-121>)

UW Bothell students are expected to maintain the highest standards of academic integrity and behavioral conduct. Students, faculty, and staff are asked to report whenever misconduct is observed or suspected. When in doubt regarding a possible infringement of the code, ask for guidance before acting.

Quantitative Skills Center

The Quantitative Skills Center supports students through peer consulting services, and it is open in person and online! For more information please go to [Quantitative Skills Center](#) (https://grad.uw.edu/campus_resources/quantitative-skills-center/).

Access and Accommodations

Access and Accommodations: Your experience in this class is important to me. It is the policy and practice of the University of Washington to create inclusive and accessible learning environments consistent with federal and state law. If you have already established accommodations with

Disability Resources for Students (DRS), please activate your accommodations via [myDRS](#)  (<http://depts.washington.edu/uwdrs/>) so we can discuss how they will be implemented in this course.

If you have not yet established services through DRS, but have a health condition or permanent disability that requires accommodations (conditions include but not limited to; mental health, attention-related, learning, vision, hearing, physical or health impacts), contact DRS directly to set up an Access Plan. DRS facilitates the interactive process that establishes reasonable accommodations. Contact DRS at uwbdrs@uw.edu (<mailto:uwbdrs@uw.edu>).

Religious Accommodation

“Washington state law requires that UW develop a policy for accommodation of student absences or significant hardship due to reasons of faith or conscience, or for organized religious activities. The UW’s policy, including more information about how to request an accommodation, is available at [Religious Accommodations Policy](#)  (<https://registrar.washington.edu/staffandfaculty/religious-accommodations-policy/>). Accommodations must be requested within the first two weeks of this course using the [Religious Accommodations Request Form](#)  (<https://registrar.washington.edu/students/religious-accommodations-request/>).”

Class Policy Regarding Religious Accommodation

Once the student has received notice of the dates associated with the religious accommodation from the Office of the University Registrar, the student must request and meet with the instructor to coordinate the class-specific accommodations. The meeting must take place at least one week in advance of the anticipated absence. Retroactive accommodation cannot be granted. Because religious holidays are scheduled in advance, students must complete the course work they miss prior to the anticipated absence. If the instructor deems this unfeasible, students will be allowed to complete the course work after the absence but prior to the next scheduled class meeting. In the event that a religious holiday should fall during the final examination week, the student must meet with the instructor at least two weeks prior to the scheduled time in order to postpone or move the final examination to an earlier time within the final examination week.

Course Roadmap

This is the tentative course roadmap, which is subject to change based on the progress made throughout the quarter.

- Week 1
 - Opportunity Cost, Comparative Advantage & Production Possibility Frontier (Chapter 1 & 2)
 - Macroeconomics: The Big Picture (Chapter 6)
- Week 2

- Supply & Demand (Chapter 3)
- **Week 3**
 - Price Controls and Quotas (Chapter 4)
 - International Trade (Chapter 5)
- **Week 4**
 - Measuring the Price Level and Inflation (Chapter 7)
 - Measuring Economic Activity: GDP and Unemployment (Chapter 8)
- **Week 5**
 - Long-Run Economic Growth (Chapter 9)
 - Review Session and Q&A for Midterm Exam
- **Week 6**
 - **Midterm Exam on February 9**
 - Saving, Investment Spending, and the Financial System (Chapter 10)
- **Week 7**
 - Income and Expenditure (Chapter 11)
- **Week 8**
 - Aggregate Demand & Aggregate Supply (Chapter 12)
 - Fiscal Policy (Chapter 13)
- **Week 9**
 - Money and Banking (Chapter 14)
 - Monetary Policy & The Federal Reserve System (Chapter 15)
- **Week 10**
 - Recent Macroeconomics Crisis & History (Chapter 17)
 - Review Session and Q&A for Final Exam
- **Finals Week**
 - **Cumulative Final Exam on March 16**